

SUMMATIVE ASSESSMENT - I (SA-1) EXAMINATION (2026-27)

CLASS: VII | SUBJECT: GENERAL ENGLISH

Time Allowed: 2 Hours 30 Minutes | **Maximum Marks:** 80 Marks

General Instructions:

1. This paper is divided into FOUR sections:
 2. **Section A: Reading Comprehension** (20 Marks)
 3. **Section B: Writing & Composition** (15 Marks)
 4. **Section C: Grammar & Vocabulary** (25 Marks)
 5. **Section D: Literature & Poetry** (20 Marks)
 6. All questions are compulsory. Marks are indicated against each question.
 7. Write clean, legible answers maintaining correct spelling and punctuation.
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SECTION A: READING COMPREHENSION (20 Marks)

**I. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow:
[10 Marks]**

"Once, in the ancient city of Granada, there lived a poor mason. He could barely afford to feed his large family. One night, as he lay resting, he was suddenly awakened by a knock at his door. When he opened it, he saw a tall, pale stranger with a serious and haunting look on his face. 'Good evening,' the man said, 'I have heard that you are an honest man. I am in need of someone I can trust. Would you be willing to carry out a task for me this very night?' The mason agreed on the condition that the work was fair. The stranger blindfolded him and guided him through twisting alleys to a grand hall with a Moorish fountain."

1. Where did the poor mason live, and what problem was he facing? [2M]
 2. Describe the appearance of the stranger who knocked at the door. [2M]
 3. Why did the stranger choose the mason for the midnight task? [2M]
 4. What condition did the stranger put forward before starting the journey? [2M]
 5. Find words from the passage which mean: [2M]
 6. (a) A person who builds walls with stone or brick: _____
 7. (b) A narrow street or passageway: _____
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II. Read the poetic lines and answer the questions: [10 Marks]

"The new hath come and now the old retires:
And sorrow from the heart must pass away,
As mist before the sunbeam's rising ray.
The future beckons like a radiant bride,
While memory's hermit dwells on mountains wide."

1. What must pass away from the human heart according to the poet? [2M]
2. What natural comparison (simile) is used to describe the disappearance of sorrow? [2M]
3. What poetic image (metaphor) is used to represent the future? [2M]
4. How is the past depicted in the poem? [2M]
5. Identify the rhyme scheme of the given lines. [2M]

SECTION B: WRITING & COMPOSITION (15 Marks)

1. **Dialogue Writing:** [7 Marks]
Imagine you meet a mysterious traveler who claims to have discovered an underground secret chamber filled with ancient coins and symbols. Write a conversation between you and the traveler in about 8 to 10 dialogues.
2. **Letter Writing:** [8 Marks]
(Attempt any ONE of the following)
3. **(A) Formal Letter:** Write a letter to your School Principal requesting permission to organize a 'Railway Safety & Bravery Exhibition' inspired by the story *The Train Saviours*.
4. **(B) Informal Letter:** Write a letter to your friend describing how the Happy Prince and the little Swallow sacrificed everything to bring joy to the suffering citizens of their town.

SECTION C: GRAMMAR & VOCABULARY (25 Marks)

I. Active and Passive Voice: [6 Marks]

Rewrite the following sentences in Passive Voice:

1. The stranger blindfolded the mason. [1M]
2. The children made six flags from red petticoats. [1M]
3. The Happy Prince gave away his sapphire eyes to the poor. [1M]

Rewrite the following sentences in Active Voice:

4. A small wall was constructed inside the courtyard by the mason. [1M]
 5. The runaway train was stopped by the brave children. [1M]
 6. The broken lead heart was thrown on the dustheap by the workmen. [1M]
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II. Direct and Indirect (Reported) Speech: [6 Marks]

Change the following into Indirect Speech:

1. Peter said, "The 11:29 train is approaching fast." [2M]
 2. Bobbie cried, "I hear a strange sound in the hillside bushes." [2M]
 3. The Prince said to the swallow, "Take the ruby from my sword-hilt." [2M]
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III. Compound Words: [5 Marks]

Classify each compound word as Closed, Hyphenated, or Open:

1. **courtyard** $\rightarrow$ ____
 2. **lantern-light** $\rightarrow$ ____
 3. **gold coins** $\rightarrow$ ____
 4. **deathbed** $\rightarrow$ ____
 5. **well-known** $\rightarrow$ ____
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IV. Phrasal Verbs & Register: [8 Marks]

(A) Fill in the blanks with suitable phrasal verbs from the box: [4M]

(give away, break down, fly away, look after)

1. The little bird refused to _ **to Egypt and stayed with the blind Prince.**
2. **The Prince decided to** _ all his fine golden leaves to starving children.
3. The mother struggled to _ **her sick child in the cold attic.**
4. **When the swallow died, the leaden heart seemed to** _ into two.

(B) Convert the informal statements into formal language: [4M]

1. "Can you give this to the boy?" $\rightarrow$ ____
 2. "I'm telling you, it's really bad." $\rightarrow$ ____
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SECTION D: LITERATURE & TEXTBOOK QUESTIONS (20 Marks)

I. Reference to Context (RTC): [6 Marks]

"Stop, stop, please stop! she screamed. But the sound of the train was too loud — no one could hear her."

1. Who is 'she' in the given line? [2M]
 2. Why was she screaming at the roaring train? [2M]
 3. What danger lay directly on the railway tracks around the curve? [2M]
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II. Short Answer Questions: (Answer any 4) [4 × 2 = 8 Marks]

1. How did the mason discover that the sacks he carried did not contain corpses?
 2. Why did Peter decide not to run to the railway station to give the warning?
 3. What two most precious things did the angel bring from the city to God's throne?
 4. How did the landlord's ruined house prove to be a blessing for the poor mason?
 5. Why did the Happy Prince weep when he was placed upon the tall pillar?
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III. Long Analytical Question: (Answer any 1) [1 × 6 = 6 Marks]

1. **Character Sketch & Moral Lesson:**
Compare the character of the **Happy Prince** with that of the **poor mason**. How did both characters demonstrate selflessness, honesty, and empathy, and what lasting values do they teach students today?
 2. **Bravery & Presence of Mind:**
Narrate how Bobbie, Peter, and Phyllis averted a catastrophic railway disaster in *The Train Saviours*. What qualities make ordinary children real-life heroes?
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ALL THE BEST